Figure 2.12 The request comes into the pipeline at the top and flows through all middlewares until it reaches Razor Pages, where it is processed and returned as a response.

This is how a request for the home page of your sample application might flow. Each middleware examines the request and determines whether it needs to do anything before passing the request on to the next middleware in the pipeline. Once the request has reached Razor Pages and has been processed, the response flows back to the server as the pipeline continues in the opposite direction. The pipeline itself begins and ends at the web server. In figure 2.13, the static file middleware makes a decision and either passes control on to the next middleware or short-circuits the process and returns a response.